PROactive PRONUNCIATION

“EH EE” /eI/ Vs. “EH” /ɛ/ Minimal Pairs

Go through the words below to compare the sounds of the diphthong /eI/ “eh ee” versus the /ɛ/ “eh.” Compare the /ɛ/ sound on its own without the tail sound first. Extend the "ee" sound after the "eh" sound to hear the transition from one vowel to another. If you are unsure, record yourself and hear the longer elongated "ee" tail sound to compare.

/eI/ vs	/ɛ/
late	let
chase	chess
wait	wet
fade	fed
take	tech
age	edge
waste	west
aid	Ed
ace	S
wage	wedge
taste	test
gate	get
main	men
fail	fell
sail	sell
raid	red
whale	well
Yale	yell